Someone searching for a tracker-less torrent will input his search term in his client and this is sent to all the peers the client is in contact with. The peers in turn will send out the query to other peers until a matching torrent is found. This is then reported back to originating peer for further action. This process however is slow; “peering,” as it is called, will take time, and some searches may never return a successful result.

The other method, which is somewhat faster in building the peer network, is to first built up a “peer routing table” (contact details of peers) by downloading tracker-based torrents. Since the tracker contains information about other peers in the torrent, your peer routing table will get built that much faster. You can then use this initial peer network to query for your tracker-less torrent. One should note that there are no reliability guarantees with a tracker-less torrent and the ability of peers who want your file is curtailed by the “best effort” principle. That is, BitTorrent will make the best effort to connect a peer to your tracker-less torrent but there is no assurance of it happening.

That said, if you are sufficiently patient and leave your client and net connection up and running, and assuming you have a ready fan base to download your files, eventually your torrent will get reseeded across many peers. This is applicable to both tracker-based as well as tracker-less torrents. The only difference is that reseeding your torrent will be much faster with a tracker-based system than a tracker-less system.

13.3 Storing Online

The only downside with file sharing through P2P is the need to be constantly connected to the Internet. With a large number of files being shared or torrented this can quickly hog up quite a bit of both download and upload traffic which in turn may result in huge Internet bills. If this describes you, or if you are simply not comfortable with the idea of P2P file sharing, you might want to